

1. Cloud Computing

Yes, I use cloud computing services in my daily life. The 3 cloud services that I have used currently are Google Drive, Gmail, and OneDrive. Google Drive allows me to store documents, presentations, and other files online. This is useful because I can access my files from different devices without carrying a flash drive. I can also share files with other people and work on documents together.

Gmail is a cloud-based email service. My emails are stored online, which means I can access them from my phone, laptop, or another computer if I have an internet connection. This makes communication easier and more convenient.

OneDrive is another cloud storage service that allows me to save and back up my files online. It helps protect my work from being lost if my computer has a problem. Cloud computing makes my daily life easier because I can access, store, share, and manage information from almost anywhere.

2. Traditional Software and OSS Alternatives

Traditional Software	OSS Alternative
Microsoft Office	LibreOffice
Adobe Photoshop	GIMP
Microsoft Visual Studio	Apache NetBeans/ Eclipse

I have used open-source software, but I have not extensively investigated the source code behind the software. Although the source code is publicly available, understanding and modifying a large open-source project requires knowledge of programming, software architecture and version-control systems.

I have also not made significant contributions to the open-source community. However, programming students can contribute in different ways, such as fixing bugs, improving documentation, reporting problems, answering questions, testing software or submitting code changes.

3.

Open-source software is important because it allows developers to access, study, modify and improve source code. This encourages collaboration and allows developers to learn from existing software projects. Open source can also provide greater flexibility and reduce software costs for organisations (Open Source Initiative, 2026)

For Information Systems professionals, open-source software is useful because it helps them work with different technologies and understand how software is developed. It also gives professionals opportunities to collaborate with other developers and solve problems together.

Programming students should use open-source resources to improve their programming skills by studying existing code, working on real projects and contributing to open-source communities. Platforms such as GitHub allow students to collaborate on projects and gain real-world software development experience (GitHub, 2026).

Students can also create their own projects and upload them to GitHub. This helps them build a portfolio that they can show potential employers. Contributing to open-source projects can demonstrate practical programming, collaboration and problem-solving skills, which can improve their credibility when applying for jobs (GitHub, 2026).

References

GitHub. (2026). Retrieved from <https://docs.github.com/en/education/about-github-education/github-education-for-students>

Open Source Initiative. (2026). Retrieved from <https://opensource.org/osd>